BONUS GUIDE — THE POTTERY TEMPLATE VAULT

The Pottery Seller's Blueprint™

Pricing that actually profits. Listings that get found. Copy that sells for you — every time.

4 complete systems · Print & use today



The Gap Between Making and Selling

You now have 100 templates. You can create pieces with consistent shape, accurate dimensions, and professional results. That part is solved.

What most potters never figure out is the other half: how to price them so you actually make money, how to write listings that get found on Etsy, how to talk about your work on social media without feeling awkward, and how to write product descriptions that turn browsers into buyers.

This guide covers all four. Work through it once, set your systems up, and you won't have to figure it out again for every piece you list.

> **How to use this guide:** Read each section once to understand it, then use the templates and scripts as your working toolkit. No need to memorize anything — just fill in the blanks and apply.

The 3-Part Pricing Formula

Most potters undercharge. They add up materials, multiply by some number they guessed at, and end up working for less than minimum wage once studio time is counted. Here is the formula that fixes that.

YOUR PRICE =

Materials + Time + Overhead + Profit Margin

Never skip a column. Every piece that skips one is a piece that loses money.

STEP 1 — MATERIALS COST

Track every consumable for each piece:

Item	How to calculate	Example
Clay	Weight used ÷ bag weight × bag price	500g used, 12.5kg bag = $20. Cost: $0.80
Glaze	Coats × surface area × unit price	3 coats, 200cm², $0.03/cm². Cost: $0.18
Kiln firing	Your cost per firing ÷ pieces per load	$15 firing, 20 pieces. Cost: $0.75/piece
Packaging	Actual cost of box + tissue + label	$0.45 typical for small mug

> **Rule:** If you are unsure of a cost, round up, not down. The market will not pay you back for guessing low.

STEP 2 — TIME COST

Set your hourly rate first. A minimum starting point for craft work in English-speaking markets is **$20/hr**. Track time for each stage:

- Wedging and preparing clay: _____ min
- Throwing or hand-building: _____ min
- Trimming and refining: _____ min
- Decorating and glazing: _____ min
- Loading/unloading kiln (shared across batch): _____ min

Total minutes ÷ 60 × hourly rate = **time cost per piece**.

STEP 3 — OVERHEAD

Monthly studio costs ÷ pieces you make per month. Include:

- Rent or studio share
- Electricity (kilns use significant power — check your bill)
- Tools and equipment depreciation (~10% of cost per year ÷ 12)
- Etsy fees and payment processing (~10-12% of sale price)
- Shipping supplies (boxes, tape, bubble wrap)

STEP 4 — PROFIT MARGIN

> Add **30–50% markup** to your total cost. This is not greed — it funds your next batch of materials, replaces tools, and makes the business sustainable. At 30%, you break even on a bad month. At 50%, you can grow.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Component	Amount
Materials (clay + glaze + firing + packaging)	$2.18
Time (45 min at $20/hr)	$15.00
Overhead (your share per piece)	$2.50
Subtotal	$19.68
40% profit margin	$7.87
Minimum sale price	**$27.55**

If the market in your category is averaging $18, do not lower your price. Either lower your time cost (batch more pieces), target a higher-end niche, or choose a different shape that can be priced correctly.

PRICE ANCHORING

List a "set of 2" or "set of 4" alongside single pieces. The set looks like a bargain even at 1.8× the single price. Buyers who hesitate on a $28 mug will often buy a set of 2 at $49 because the math feels like a deal.

The Etsy SEO Checklist

Etsy ranks listings based on how well they match what buyers search for. These 15 points are the difference between a listing buried on page 7 and one that shows up first.

TITLE (MOST IMPORTANT FIELD)

- ☐ Lead with the most specific phrase buyers actually type (not your product name — what they search for). Example: "Handmade Stoneware Mug" not "River Clay Studio Morning Cup".
- ☐ Include the primary material (stoneware, earthenware, porcelain) in the first 30 characters.
- ☐ Include the finish/style (matte glaze, speckled, rustic, minimalist) in the first 60 characters.
- ☐ Add a use case or occasion at the end of the title (coffee lover gift, housewarming gift, pottery lover).
- ☐ Use commas to separate keyword phrases — Etsy treats them as separate searchable strings.

> **Good title example:**
> Handmade Stoneware Mug, Matte White Glaze, Minimalist Coffee Cup, Pottery Gift for Her, Ceramic Morning Mug, Wheel Thrown

TAGS (13 AVAILABLE — USE ALL 13)

- ☐ Use all 13 tags. Every empty tag is a missed opportunity.
- ☐ Each tag can be up to 20 characters. Multi-word tags ("handmade mug") outperform single words ("mug").
- ☐ Cover: material, technique, occasion, recipient, style, color, size, and use case — one angle per tag.
- ☐ Don't repeat your title's exact phrases in tags — use synonyms and related searches.
- ☐ Check "Etsy Search Analytics" in your dashboard monthly and replace low-traffic tags.

PHOTOS (ETSY USES THEM TO CLASSIFY LISTINGS)

- ☐ First photo: clean white or natural-linen background, product fills 80% of frame, sharp focus.
- ☐ Second photo: lifestyle shot showing the piece in use (coffee being poured, plant in the pot).

- [ ] Third photo: scale reference — a hand holding it, or a coin beside it.
- [ ] Add alt-text to every photo. Use your primary keyword phrase naturally.
- [ ] Rename files before upload: "handmade-stoneware-mug-matte-white.jpg" beats "IMG_4829.jpg".

DESCRIPTION

- [ ] First sentence: repeat your primary search phrase naturally. "This handmade stoneware mug..."
- [ ] Mention dimensions in the first paragraph. Buyers who don't know the size, don't buy.
- [ ] Include the clay body, firing temperature, and food/microwave/dishwasher safety clearly.

Social Post Scripts

These scripts are ready to copy, fill in the blanks, and post. Each one is written to work on its own — no need to build a following first. They work by being specific and honest about the process.

INSTAGRAM — 5 CAPTIONS READY TO USE

INSTAGRAM — PROCESS POST

> *The difference between a piece that warps and one that doesn't? [SPECIFIC THING YOU DO — e.g., "the thickness of the base before trimming"].*
>
> *I learned this the hard way after [NUMBER] failed [PIECE TYPE]s. Now it's the first thing I check.*
>
> *The [PIECE TYPE] in this photo took [TIME]. The template I use to get the [DIMENSION — e.g., "6-inch opening"] consistent every time is linked in bio.*
>
> *#handmadepottery #[PIECE TYPE]maker #ceramicsofinstagram #wheelthrownceramics #potterystudio*

INSTAGRAM — PRODUCT DROP

> *New in the shop: [PIECE NAME AND SIZE]. [ONE LINE ABOUT WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT — e.g., "The opening is designed for a standard drip coffee maker — no overflow, no mess."]*
>
> *[GLAZE/CLAY DETAILS]. [FOOD SAFE Y/N]. [HOW MANY AVAILABLE].*
>
> *Link in bio. Ships in [TIMEFRAME].*
>
> *#handmadepottery #ceramicsofinstagram #shopsmall #[LOCATION]pottery #[PIECE TYPE]*

INSTAGRAM — BEHIND THE SCENES

> *This is what [NUMBER] hours of work looks like before it goes in the kiln.*
>
> *[DESCRIBE WHAT'S IN THE PHOTO — e.g., "24 mugs, all at the leather-hard stage, waiting for handles."] Each one took about [TIME] on the wheel. Then another [TIME] to attach handles. Then [DRYING/BISQUE FIRING TIME] before I can even think about glazing.*
>
> *Pottery isn't fast. That's why it's priced the way it is.*
>
> *[LINK IN BIO] to see what's available.*

INSTAGRAM — GIFT SEASON

> *If you have someone in your life who drinks coffee/tea/[RELEVANT DRINK] every single morning, this is the gift that actually gets used.*
>
> *[PIECE NAME]. Holds [VOLUME]. [GLAZE COLOR — e.g., "Matte sage on the outside, glossy white inside"]. [CLAY BODY — e.g., Stoneware]. Safe for microwave and dishwasher.*
>
> *[NUMBER] available. Link in bio — ships within [TIMEFRAME].*
>
> *#handmadeceramics #giftforher #giftforhim #ceramicmug #[LOCATION]maker #holidaygifts*

INSTAGRAM — SOLD OUT / SOCIAL PROOF

> *That batch of [PIECE NAME]s sold out in [TIMEFRAME]. Thank you.*
>
> *The next batch goes in the kiln [DATE]. If you want one, [HOW TO GET NOTIFIED — e.g., "follow this account and turn on notifications / join the waitlist via link in bio"].*
>
> *Same [GLAZE/COLOR DESCRIPTION]. Same [DIMENSION]. [NUMBER] pieces only.*

TIKTOK — 5 HOOK + SCRIPT FORMATS

TIKTOK — "THE THING NOBODY TELLS YOU"

> ***Hook:*** *"The thing nobody tells you about [SPECIFIC POTTERY PROBLEM — e.g., handles falling off]."*
>
> ***Body:*** *"It's not the clay. It's not the temperature. It's [ACTUAL CAUSE — e.g., the moisture difference between the handle and the body when you attach them]. Here's how to fix it:" [Show 3 steps on screen].*
>
> ***Closing:*** *"If this saved you a piece, follow for more. I post fixes every week."*

TIKTOK — PROCESS VIDEO

> ***Hook (on screen text):*** *"Throwing [NUMBER] [PIECE TYPE]s in [TIME]"*
>
> ***Audio:*** *[Use trending audio or your own voice] Time-lapse of the throwing process.*
>
> ***Text overlay at end:*** *"All [NUMBER] are in the shop. Link in bio."*
>
> ***Caption:*** *"Batch day. [NUMBER] [PIECE TYPE]s, [NUMBER] hours. Available in the shop — link in bio. #pottery #wheelthrown #ceramics #handmade"*

TIKTOK — PRICING TRANSPARENCY

> ***Hook:*** *"Why does this [PIECE] cost $[PRICE]? Let me show you."*
>
> ***Body:*** *Break down on screen — clay cost, firing, your time, platform fees. Total it up. "And that's before profit."*
>
> ***Closing:*** *"Handmade pottery isn't expensive. Mass production made us forget what things actually cost to make."*

TIKTOK — BEFORE & AFTER

> ***Structure:*** *3-second clip of raw clay ball → 3-second clip of finished glazed piece.*
>
> ***On screen text:*** *"From this → to this. [TIME] from start to finish."*
>
> ***Caption:*** *"The full process from raw clay to finished [PIECE TYPE]. Available in the shop now — link in bio. #handmadeceramics #pottery #ceramicart"*

TIKTOK — Q&A / COMMENT REPLY

> ***Prompt:*** *Post a simple process video. In comments, ask: "What part of pottery do you want me to explain?" Reply to the first good comment as a video reply.*
>
> ***Video reply hook:*** *"You asked about [TOPIC]. Here's the honest answer." [Give a 30-60 second real explanation]. End with: "Drop your next question below."*
>
> *This format often outperforms original content because TikTok promotes comment-reply chains.*

Product Description Templates

These three templates cover the main piece types you will list. Each one is structured so Etsy can index it properly and buyers can find the information they actually want.

Replace every *[BRACKETED FIELD]* with your real details. Do not leave any blanks unfilled before publishing.

Template 1 — Mugs & Cups

[DESCRIPTIVE ADJECTIVE — e.g., Handmade Stoneware] Mug · *[CAPACITY — e.g., 12 oz / 350ml]* · *[GLAZE COLOR & FINISH — e.g., Matte Sage Green Outside, Glossy White Inside]*

This mug is *[CLAY TYPE — e.g., stoneware]*, thrown on the wheel by hand and trimmed to a *[WEIGHT — e.g., 280g]* finished weight. The *[GLAZE]* glaze is food-safe, lead-free, and *[microwave safe / not microwave safe]*.

Dimensions: *[HEIGHT]* tall · *[OPENING DIAMETER]* opening · *[BASE DIAMETER]* base · holds *[CAPACITY]*.

Care: *[Dishwasher safe / Hand wash recommended]*. *[Microwave safe / Not suitable for microwave]*.

Each piece is individually made, so slight variations in glaze and proportion are part of what you receive — not a defect.

Ships in: *[TIMEFRAME]*, double-boxed with recycled paper padding. *[RETURNS POLICY — e.g., "I accept returns within 14 days if the piece arrives damaged."]*

Template 2 — Bowls & Plates

[CLAY TYPE] *[PIECE TYPE — Bowl / Plate / Pasta Bowl]* · *[DIAMETER]* · *[GLAZE DESCRIPTION]*

A *[SIZE DESCRIPTOR — e.g., generous 7-inch]* *[PIECE TYPE]*, wheel-thrown in *[CLAY TYPE]* and fired to *[CONE/TEMPERATURE]*. Good for *[USE CASES — e.g., soup, pasta, cereal, salad]*.

Dimensions: *[DIAMETER]* wide · *[DEPTH]* deep · *[WEIGHT]* · holds approx. *[CAPACITY]*.

Food safe: Yes. Lead-free glaze. *[Microwave/dishwasher details]*.

Available in: *[COLORS/GLAZES AVAILABLE — if applicable]*. If you would like a specific glaze from my available range, *[message me / see my other listings]*.

Ships in: *[TIMEFRAME]*. Packed securely for transit.

Template 3 — Vases & Decorative Pieces

[CLAY TYPE] Vase · *[HEIGHT]* · *[GLAZE & FINISH]* · *[STYLE — e.g., Minimalist / Rustic / Textured]*

A *[HEIGHT]* vase in *[CLAY TYPE]*, with a *[OPENING DIAMETER]* opening. Suited for *[STEM TYPES — e.g., single stems, dried grasses, small bouquets]*.

Glaze: *[GLAZE DESCRIPTION]*. *[Waterproof / Not waterproof — and if it needs a liner]*.

Dimensions: *[H × OPENING × BASE]* · *[WEIGHT]*.

Styling: *[ONE LINE ABOUT HOW IT LOOKS IN A ROOM — e.g., "The matte white glaze works in any neutral room — it disappears into the shelf and makes the flowers the focus."]*

Each piece is one of a kind. *[Number available — e.g., "This is one of 3 in this glaze run."]*

Ships in: *[TIMEFRAME]*. Packed securely.

Next Step

Pick one piece you made this week. Price it using the formula in Section 2. Write its Etsy listing using the checklist and template. Post one social caption from Section 4.

That is the whole system. Repeat it for every piece.